

Project Design Document (PDD)

Actual vs Target Financial Performance Analysis Dashboard

Technology: Microsoft Power BI

Data Source: Microsoft Excel

Domain: Financial / Sales Performance Analytics

Project Type: Business Intelligence & Data Analytics

1. Project Overview

The **Actual vs Target Financial Performance Analysis Dashboard** is an interactive Business Intelligence solution developed using Microsoft Power BI to monitor and evaluate financial performance against predefined targets.

The solution enables business users to analyze actual performance, target achievement, performance variance, and variance percentage across salespeople, teams, and reporting periods.

The dashboard transforms structured Excel data into actionable insights through data transformation, analytical modeling, DAX calculations, and interactive visualizations.

2. Business Objective

The primary objective of this project is to provide a centralized reporting solution for monitoring actual financial performance against target values.

The dashboard is designed to help stakeholders:

- Monitor overall financial performance.
- Evaluate target achievement.
- Identify performance gaps.
- Analyze salesperson-level performance.
- Compare team-level performance.
- Monitor monthly performance trends.
- Support data-driven business decisions.

3. Business Problem

Financial performance is often monitored through static spreadsheets and manually prepared reports. Such approaches can make it difficult to identify performance gaps and understand trends efficiently.

The key challenges addressed by this solution are:

- Limited visibility into Actual vs Target performance.
- Time-consuming manual calculations.
- Difficulty identifying underperforming salespeople.
- Limited team-level comparison.
- Lack of interactive reporting.
- Difficulty monitoring performance trends over time.

The proposed Power BI solution addresses these challenges by providing an interactive and centralized analytical dashboard.

4. Project Scope

The scope of the project includes:

Financial Performance Analysis

- Actual financial value
- Target financial value
- Performance variance
- Variance percentage

Sales Performance Analysis

- Salesperson-level performance
- Team-level performance
- Salesperson comparison

Time-Based Analysis

- Monthly performance
- Actual vs Target trends
- Variance trends

Interactive Analysis

- Salesperson filtering
- Team filtering
- Dynamic KPI updates

5. Dataset Overview

The solution uses an Excel-based dataset containing four logical tables:

Table	Purpose
Actual	Contains actual financial performance values
Targets	Contains target financial values
Calendar	Provides date information for time-based analysis
dimPeople	Contains salesperson, team, and picture information

The dataset contains monthly performance information for **25 salespeople**, covering the period from **January 2023 to February 2024**.

6. Key Business Metrics

Total Actual Value

Represents the total financial value achieved during the selected period.

Total Target Value

Represents the total financial target assigned for the selected period.

Variance

Measures the difference between actual performance and target performance.

Formula:

Variance = Actual Value – Target Value

Variance %

Measures the percentage difference between actual and target performance.

Formula:

Variance % = Variance / Target Value × 100

7. Dashboard Requirements

The dashboard is designed to provide the following capabilities:

1. Display overall financial KPIs.
2. Compare actual performance with target performance.
3. Calculate performance variance.
4. Calculate variance percentage.

5. Analyze individual salesperson performance.
6. Analyze team-level performance.
7. Monitor monthly performance trends.
8. Filter results using salesperson and team slicers.
9. Dynamically update analytical visuals based on user selections.

8. Target Users

The solution is intended for:

- Sales Managers
- Finance Managers
- Business Analysts
- Reporting Analysts
- Team Leaders
- Management

9. Expected Business Benefits

The solution provides:

- Faster performance monitoring.
- Reduced manual reporting effort.
- Improved visibility into target achievement.
- Easy identification of performance gaps.
- Improved salesperson and team analysis.
- Interactive self-service reporting.
- Better support for management decision-making.

10. Project Deliverables

The project deliverables include:

- Cleaned and transformed dataset.
- Power BI data model.

- DAX measures.
- Interactive financial dashboard.
- Project Design Document.
- Solution Design Document.
- Dashboard documentation.

11. Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful when:

- Actual and Target values are accurately represented.
- Variance calculations are correct.
- Variance percentages are correctly calculated.
- Salesperson and team filters work correctly.
- Monthly trends are displayed accurately.
- Dashboard visuals respond dynamically to user selections.
- Business users can interpret the dashboard without requiring technical knowledge.

12. Project Conclusion

The project provides a centralized Business Intelligence solution for evaluating financial performance against targets.

By combining data transformation, analytical modeling, DAX calculations, and interactive visualization, the dashboard converts raw financial data into meaningful business insights.

The solution enables stakeholders to identify performance gaps, evaluate target achievement, and make informed decisions using a single interactive reporting platform.